

Adding New Questions to Your Assistant

A plain-English walkthrough of how new questions, time periods, and measures are added — by editing simple settings files, no programming.

The idea in one minute

Your assistant understands questions through a set of editable **settings files** — not hidden code. To make it understand something new, you add a line or two to the right file and restart it. That's the whole model.

When someone asks a question, the system does two quick things first:

```
"How much sales did I do this week?"  
  |  
  ├── recognises the topic   → sales  
  ├── recognises the period → this week  
  |  
  ▼ looks up the answer safely and replies:  
  "This week's total sales are ₹63,000."
```

A question is understood only when the system recognises **both a topic and a time period**. If it doesn't recognise something, it says so clearly rather than guessing — that is by design.

Three things you can add

1) new **wordings** for a question you already support, 2) new **time periods** (e.g. "yesterday"), and 3) entirely new **measures** (e.g. "average sale"). Each is covered below.

Where the settings live

File	What it controls
<code>config/intent_patterns.yaml</code>	The words/phrases the assistant recognises (topics & time periods).
<code>config/orchestration.yaml</code>	Which measure a recognised topic maps to.
<code>semantic/entities/sales.yaml</code>	Which measures and time periods are <i>allowed</i> .
<code>schema_registry/mappings.yaml</code>	Where each measure comes from in the database.
<code>config/settings.yaml</code>	What each time period means (e.g. "this week" = last 7 days).

Always restart after editing

Settings are read once when the assistant starts. After saving a change, restart it so the change takes effect.

Task 1 — Recognise a new wording

Say you also want it to understand *"What was my turnover this week?"* and *"How much did I earn this month?"*. You only add the new words to the sales topic.

Edit `config/intent_patterns.yaml`

```
intents:
  - name: sales_amount
    patterns:
      - sales
      - sold
      - revenue
      - turnover      # ← new
      - earn / earned # ← new
```

That's it — the time periods ("this week", "this month", ...) are already understood, so the new wordings work immediately.

Tip

Keep wordings related to the topic. If a sentence has no sales-related word, the assistant will simply say it didn't recognise the question — it will never guess or run the wrong query.

Task 2 — Add a new time period (e.g. “yesterday”)

Time periods are checked in three small places, so add “yesterday” to each.

1 Teach the word — `config/intent_patterns.yaml`

```
periods:
  - value: yesterday    # ← new
    patterns: [ yesterday ]
  - value: today
    patterns: [ today ]
```

2 Define what it means — `config/settings.yaml`

```
periods:
  today:      { days: 0 }
  yesterday:  { days: 1 }    # ← last 1 day
  this_week:  { days: 7 }
  this_month: { days: 30 }
```

3 Allow it — `semantic/entities/sales.yaml`

```
filters:
  period:
    - today
    - yesterday    # ← new
    - this_week
    - this_month
```

Why three places?

It's a safety design: the assistant won't accept a time period unless it has been explicitly defined *and* allowed. If you miss step 2 or 3, it will clearly refuse the period instead of returning a wrong number.

Task 3 — Add a new measure (e.g. “average sale”)

To answer “What’s my average sale this month?” you add a new measure across four files. Still no programming.

1 New topic — `config/intent_patterns.yaml`

```
intents:
  - name: sales_amount
    patterns: [ sales, sold, revenue ]
  - name: average_sale      # ← new
    patterns: [ average, avg ]
```

2 Map topic → measure — `config/orchestration.yaml`

```
intents:
  sales_amount:
    entity: sales
    metric: total_sales
  average_sale:      # ← new
    entity: sales
    metric: avg_sale
```

3 Allow the measure — `semantic/entities/sales.yaml`

```
metrics:
  - total_sales
  - avg_sale      # ← new
```

4 Point it at the data — `schema_registry/mappings.yaml`

```
metrics:
  total_sales:
    column: purchase_amount
    aggregation: SUM
  avg_sale:      # ← new
    column: purchase_amount
    aggregation: AVG
```

Available calculations: `SUM`, `COUNT`, `AVG`, `MIN`, `MAX`.

If something isn't recognised

The assistant always tells you exactly where a request stopped, using a short code. Use this table to know which file to adjust.

Message you see	What it means	What to do
INTENT_NOT_FOUND	The wording or time period wasn't recognised.	Add the wording (Task 1) or period (Task 2).
SEMANTIC_VALIDATION_FAILED	The measure or period isn't allowed yet.	Allow it in <code>sales.yaml</code> (Task 2 step 3 / Task 3 step 3).
ENTITY_NOT_REGISTERED	A topic points to a measure that isn't set up.	Complete the mapping (Task 3 steps 2–3).
RBAC_DENIED	This user's role isn't allowed to see this information.	Grant access in the roles file (an administrator change).

Why this is safe to edit

- These files contain **plain settings**, not program logic.
- A mistake in wording can only lead to “I didn't recognise that” — it can never reach or change your database.
- The assistant never writes to your data; it can only read approved measures that you have explicitly allowed.
- Renaming something in the database later is a **one-line** change in a single file — nothing else needs to change.

Rule of thumb

Add the words → define what they mean → allow them → point to the data → restart. Then ask the question and watch it work end-to-end.